Tier pack: Independent route — One change, named before you make it

Pathway: TRACK · Week 5 Part 1 · Big question: How does naming one specific compositional change before touching the page lead to stronger refinement?

Independent route studio steps

Step 1: Audit your Week 4 identity piece against your Week 3 plan for figure-ground clarity and tonal range.

Step 2: Write a clear two-sentence intention on your log card naming the exact change and the tool you will use.

Step 3: Execute the refinement with controlled pressure (contour weight, shadow deepening, or opaque highlight accents).

Step 4: Write an evaluation note explaining how that single change improved the overall composition.

Success check

Written pre-action intention, executed refinement, and post-action impact evaluation.

Key words helper

• refinement: A focused, deliberate adjustment that sharpens clarity, tone, or balance.

• intention: Knowing and stating the exact visual effect you want before making a mark.

• edge quality: How crisp, bold, or soft the boundary is between two shapes.

• accent: A small touch of bright highlight or deep dark that pulls the eye to the focal point.

• audit: Checking your work honestly against your original design goals.

Review checklist

[ ] Hold your refined piece at two paces and confirm your named change achieved its goal.

[ ] Check that both the 'Before (Intention)' and 'After (Impact)' boxes are complete on your log card.

[ ] Attach your refinement card to your studio log.